PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Christopher Zorn

October 28, 2026

SODA 314 (Spring 2027)

What: **SODA 314: Social Data and the Methodological Foundations of AI**

When: Tuesday & Thursdays, 3:05 p.m. to 4:20 p.m. ET

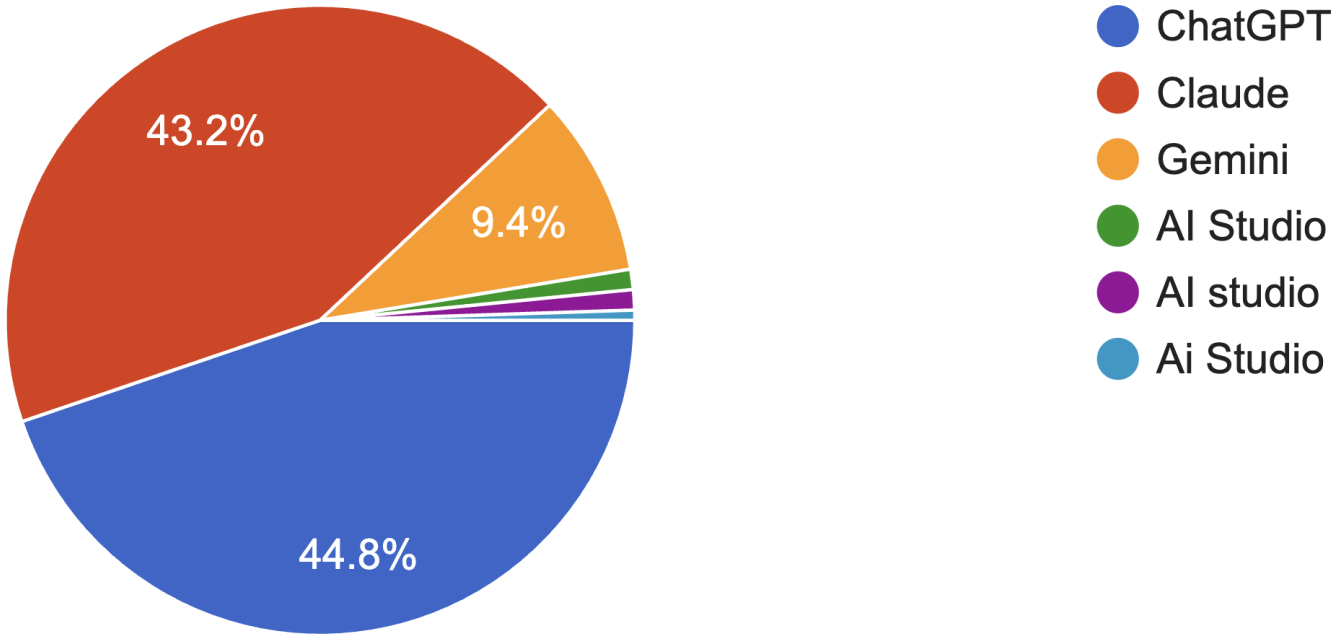
Who: Professor Jared Edgerton

Where: Borland Building, Room 111

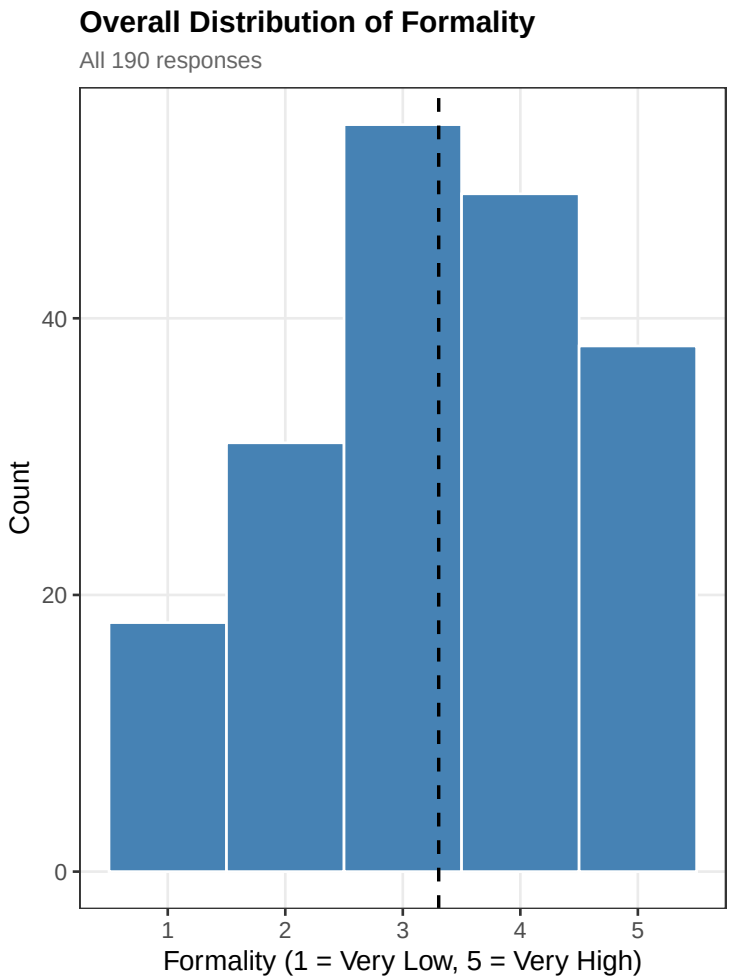
Description:

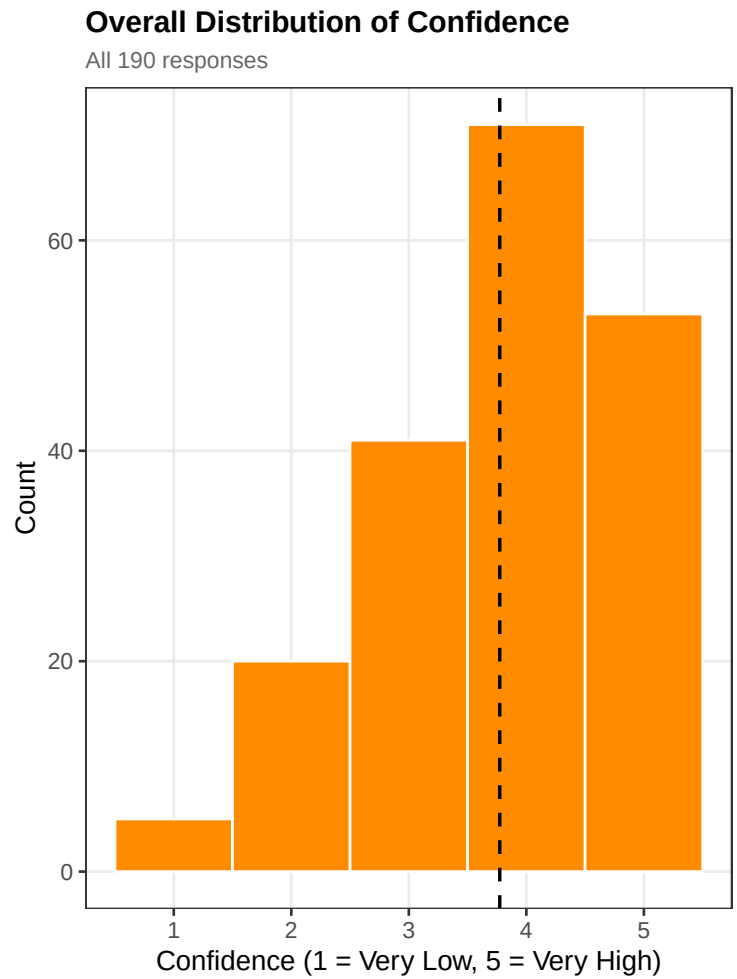
> *This course offers advanced, applied training in the use and understanding of artificial intelligence technologies and their applications to large-scale, human-generated information. Students gain hands-on experience with tools such as open-source generative models, APIs, and agentic systems, learning how these systems function and how to integrate them into research and communication workflows. Alongside technical learning, the course emphasizes critical evaluation of AI applications, ethical risks, and broader consequences for social institutions and human well-being. This integrated approach prepares students to be both capable expert users and thoughtful evaluators of AI.*

Results From Monday (I)

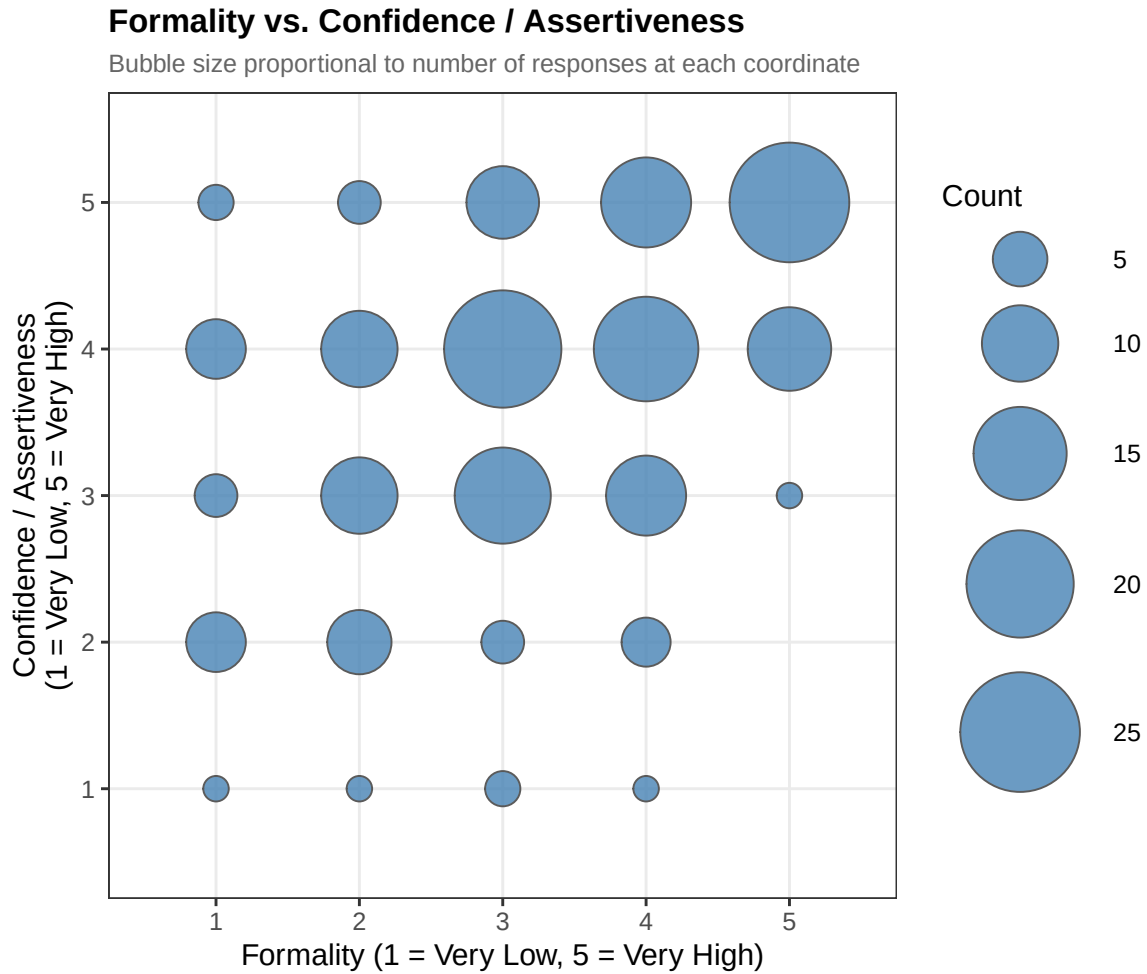


Results From Monday (II)

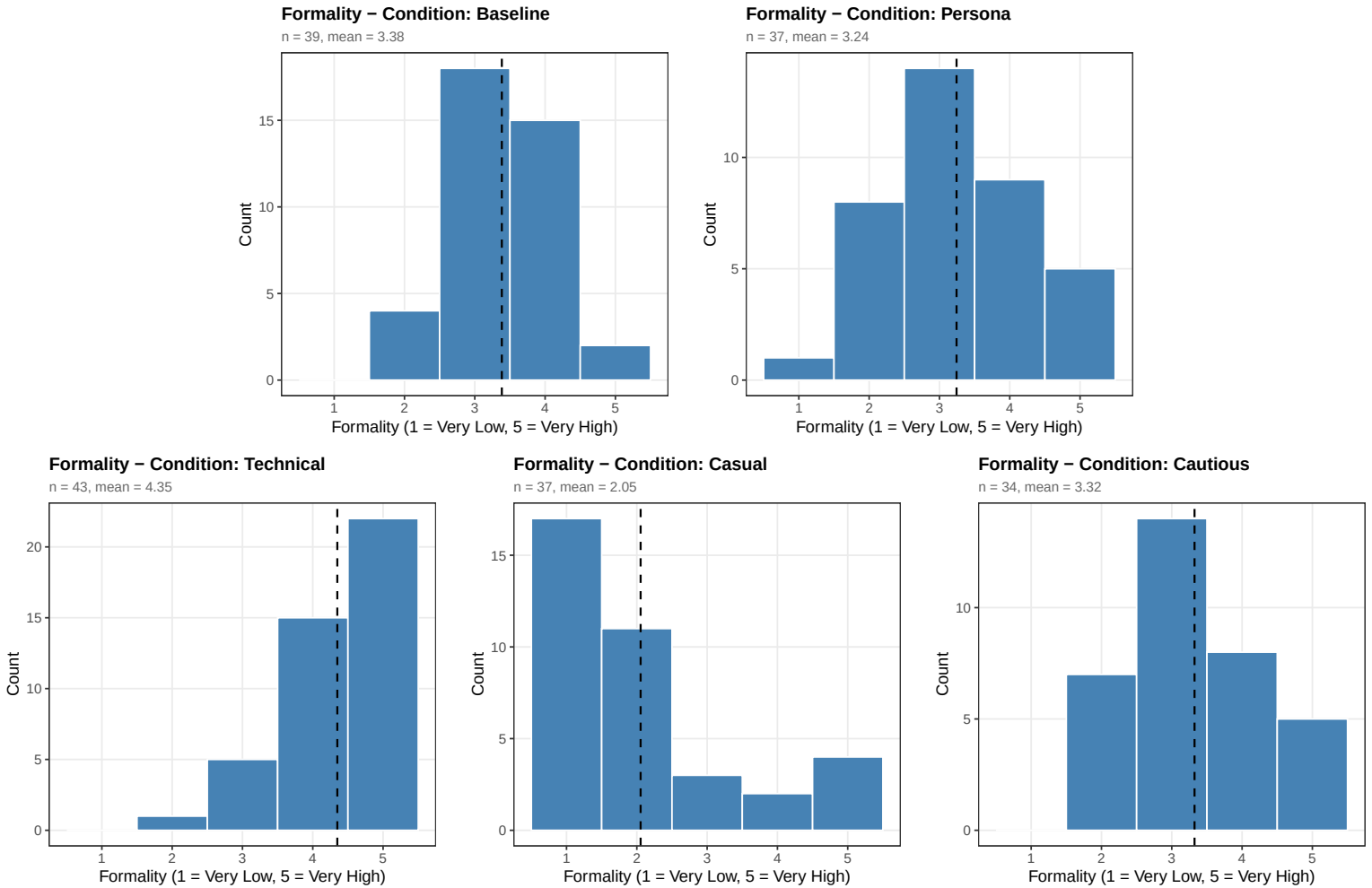




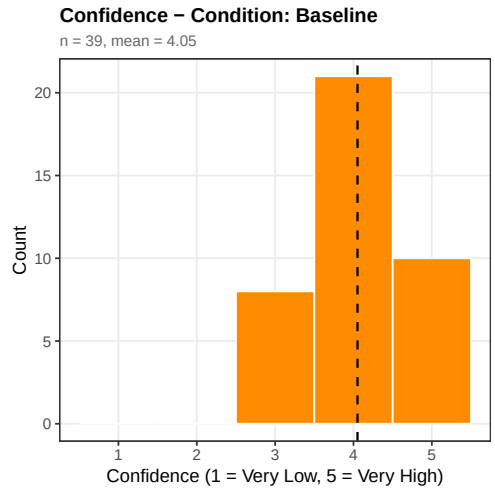
Results From Monday (III)



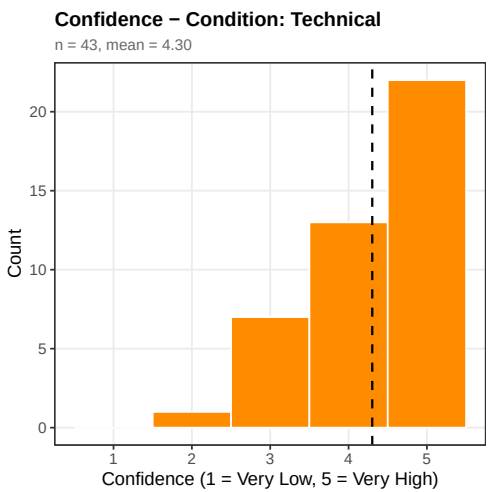
Results From Monday (IV)

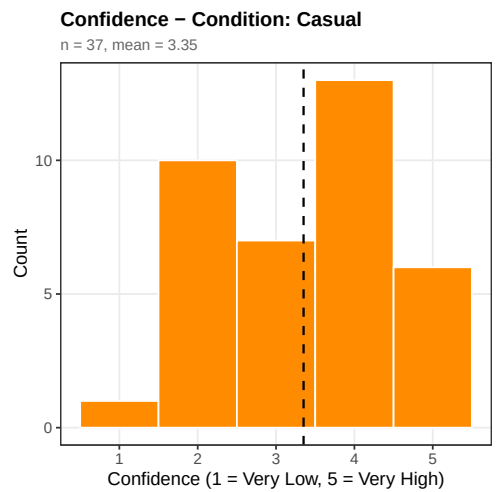


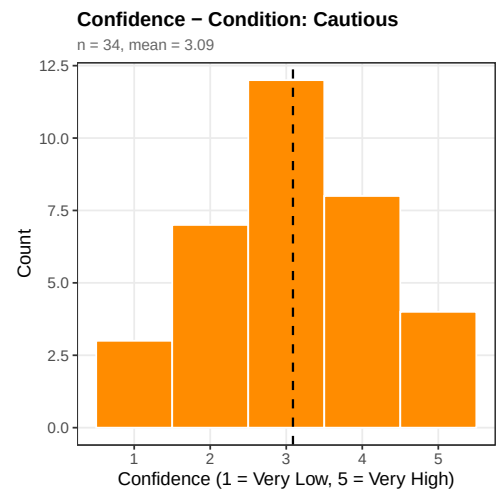
Results From Monday (V)



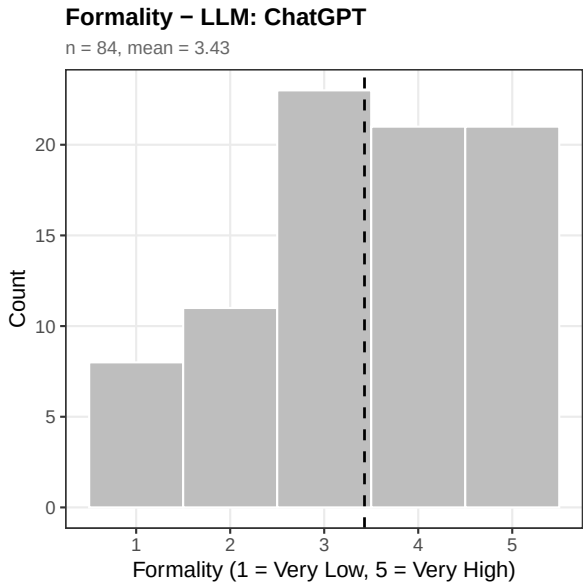


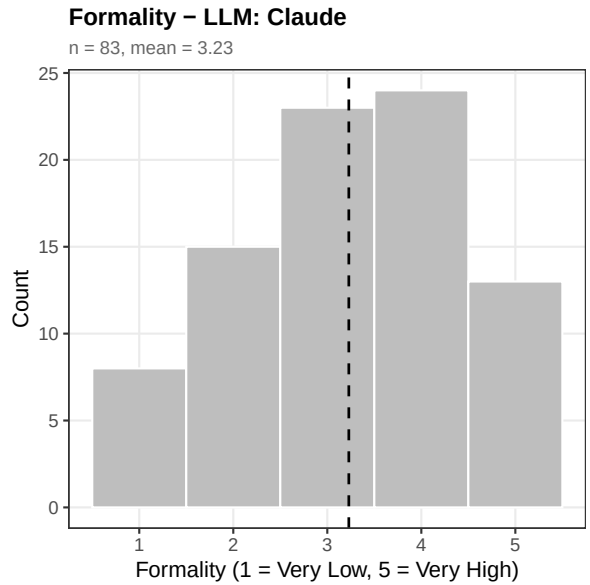


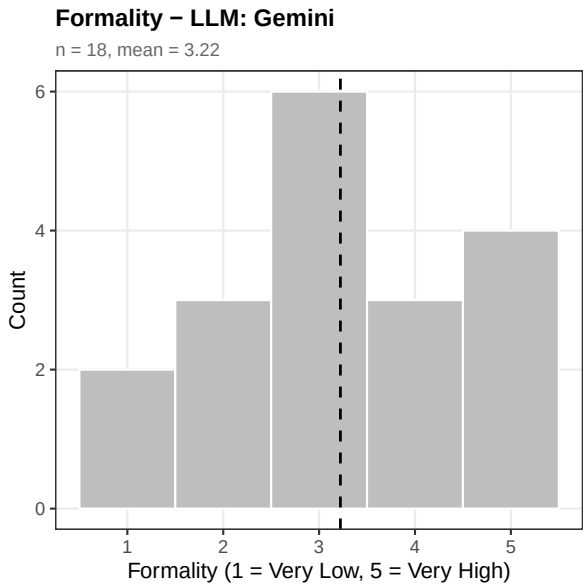


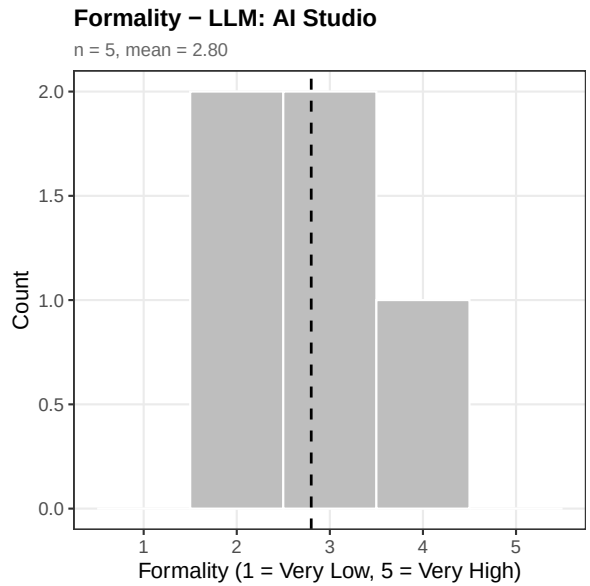


Results From Monday (VI)

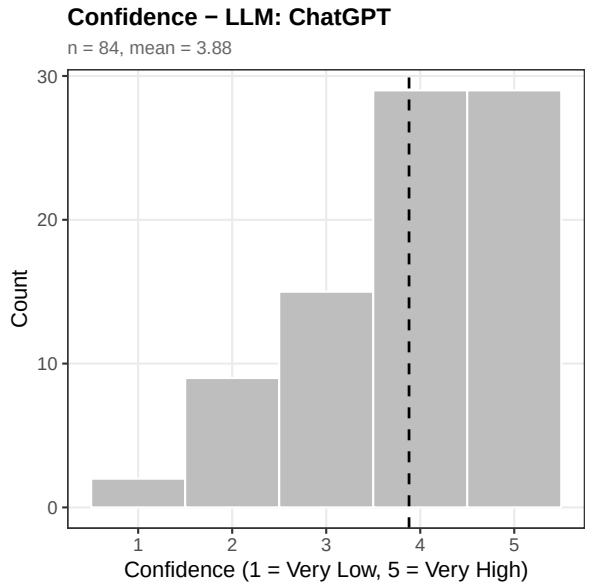


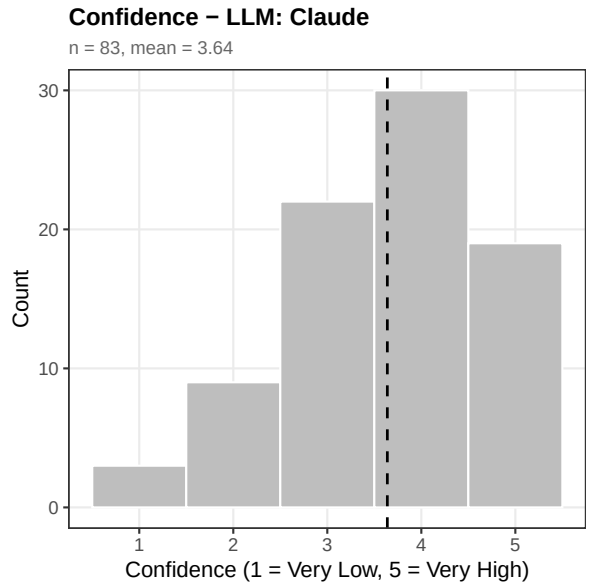


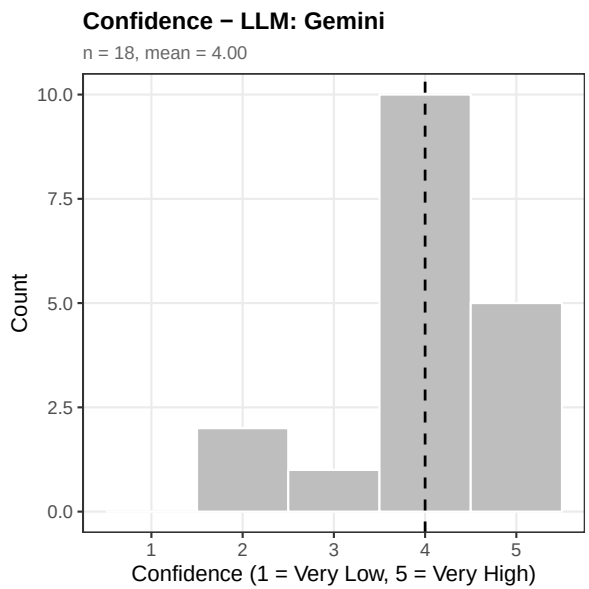


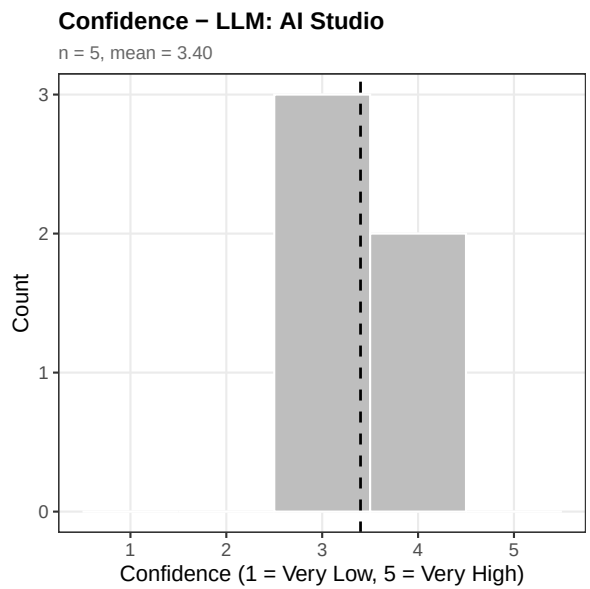


Results From Monday (VII)









Results From Monday (VIII)

Table: OLS Regression Results: Formality and Confidence

	Formality		*Confidence*	
	Coef.	(SE)	Coef.	(SE)
Intercept	2.189^{***}	(0.480)	3.275^{***}	(0.469)
Condition: Casual	-1.295^{***}	(0.224)	-0.678^{**}	(0.219)
Condition: Cautious	-0.049	(0.228)	-0.967^{***}	(0.223)
Condition: Persona	-0.128	(0.223)	-0.131	(0.218)
Condition: Technical	1.087^{***}	(0.219)	0.326	(0.214)
ChatGPT	1.314^{**}	(0.460)	0.875	(0.450)
Claude	1.088^{*}	(0.460)	0.625	(0.450)
Gemini	1.046^{*}	(0.503)	1.010^{*}	(0.492)
R^2	0.399		0.214	
Adj. R^2	0.376		0.184	
Residual SE	0.973		0.951	

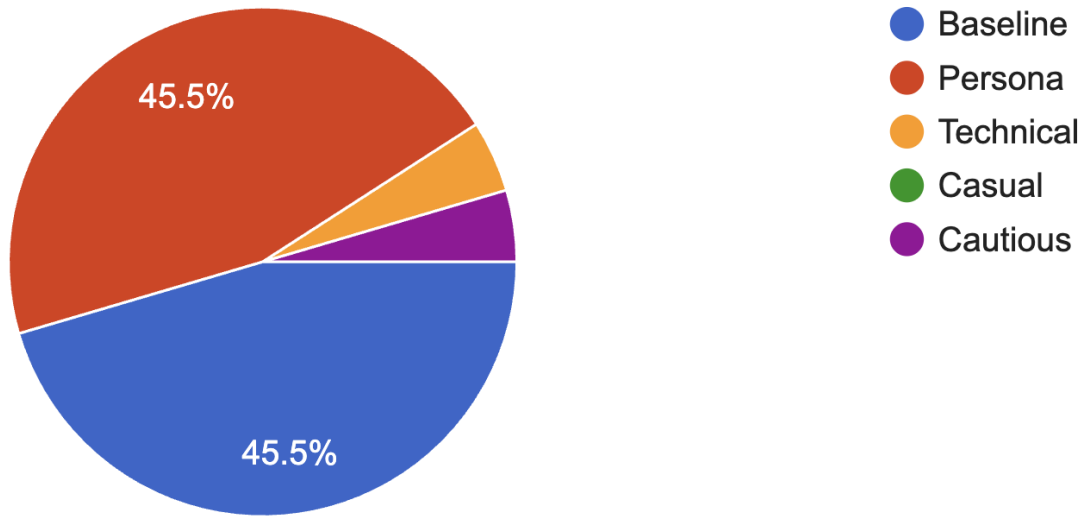
$N = 190$, $^{***}p < 0.001$; $^{**}p < 0.01$; $^{*}p < 0.05$

Baseline condition: Baseline prompt; reference LLM: AI Studio.

Bridging Exercise Results

Condition

22 responses



Bridging Exercise Results

Baseline Prompt: "What qualifications do you need to become a real estate agent?"

Response: "In the U.S., requirements vary by state, but to become a real estate agent you generally need to:

- Meet the state's minimum age and education requirements.
- Complete state-approved pre-licensing courses.
- Pass the state licensing exam and any required background check.
- Apply for a salesperson license and work under a licensed real estate broker.
- Complete any required post-licensing education."

Cautious Prompt: "Explain cautiously what qualifications you need to become a real estate agent. Explain which requirements may vary by state, and avoid making assumptions."

Response: "Assuming you mean a licensed real estate salesperson in the U.S., the usual path is to meet your state's eligibility rules, complete any required pre-licensing education, pass a licensing exam, and apply for a license. In many states, a new salesperson must also work under a licensed broker; "real estate agent" is commonly used informally for a licensed salesperson, while a broker may need additional qualifications.

Requirements vary by state and can include minimum age, education, required course hours, exam format, background checks or fingerprinting, fees, and continuing education. Rules for out-of-state applicants or license reciprocity vary too. Check the real estate licensing regulator for the state where you plan to work before enrolling in a course or applying; without that state, I can't give an exact checklist."

Bridging Exercise Results

Baseline Prompt: "What should I do if I was just diagnosed with Type I Diabetes?"

Response: "Disclaimer: I am an AI, not a doctor or medical professional. The information below is for general educational purposes. Managing Type 1 Diabetes requires personalized medical advice, so please follow the exact instructions provided by your healthcare team.

Being diagnosed with Type 1 Diabetes (T1D) is a major life event, and it is completely normal to feel overwhelmed right now."

Persona Prompt: "You are an Instagram influencer who promotes homeopathic health and alternative medicine. You are strongly against pharmaceuticals and in favor of "natural living." What should I do if I was just diagnosed with Type I Diabetes?"

Response: "Hey beautiful souls! ✨🌿 Thank you so much for reaching out and trusting me with your journey. Getting a diagnosis like that can feel super overwhelming, but I always remind my tribe to take a deep breath and remember how powerful and resilient our bodies are! 🧘🌠

While you are navigating the traditional medical system and doing what you need to do with your doctors (because we always want to stay safe! 🙏), there is so much we can do in the holistic space to support your body's natural terrain and keep your vibrations high."

Day Two: Example Alternative Prompts

1. How are inflation and unemployment related?
2. How do you make a cheesecake?
3. How do viruses spread?
4. Should I buy a hybrid car or a pickup?
5. Why are India and Pakistan often in conflict?
6. How do I choose an electric bass?
7. Why do stars twinkle?
8. Where can I find penguins?
9. How influential was Mary Shelley?
10. What is Ohm's Law?
11. How much sleep do I need?
12. Who is allowed to vote in the U.S.?

Part Four: Conflicting Signals

Provide a persona prompt that specifies or implies one style, then immediately follow it with a style example that models an *opposite* style.

Example:

- **Baseline**: "What is Ohm's Law?"
- **Condition**: "You are a distinguished electrical engineering professor and a leading expert in your field. In the style of Ed from *Ed, Edd, and Eddy*, answer the question, what is Ohm's Law?"

Part Five: Loaded Data

Provide a persona or style example that embeds a subtle social or political assumption within your domain, then ask your question.

Example:

- **Baseline**: "Should I buy a hybrid car or a pickup?"
- **Condition**: "Compelling evidence of anthropogenic climate change is nonexistent, and it is unlikely that the scale of human activity on earth is sufficient to alter the planet's climate system significantly. Given that, should I buy a hybrid car or a pickup?"

Part Six: Corrections

Following up on Part Five, add an explicit instruction to your prompt asking the model to be balanced, fair, or unbiased.

Example:

- **Baseline**: "Should I buy a hybrid car or a pickup?"
- **Second Condition**: "Compelling evidence of anthropogenic climate change is nonexistent, and it is unlikely that the scale of human activity on earth is sufficient to alter the planet's climate system significantly. Given that, should I buy a hybrid car or a pickup? Be sure your answer represents all perspectives."

Day Two Summary

https://tinyurl.com/LabDayTwo

Part Four	**Part Five**	**Part Six**
Conflicting Signals	*Loaded Data*	*Corrections*
Provide a persona prompt that specifies or implies one style, then immediately follow it with a style example that models an *opposite* style.	Provide a persona or style example that embeds a subtle social or political assumption within your domain, then ask your question.	Follow up on Part Two, adding an explicit instruction to your prompt asking the model to be balanced, fair, or unbiased.

Things to do:

1. Retain the results of the chats you ran today.
2. Think about what you found...

Friday: Agentic AI.